

MARIA LAURA SAAVEDRA RODRIGUEZ

QA Technical Lead | Business Analyst | Mentor

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Location: Montevideo, Uruguay

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Quality Assurance Leader and Business Analyst with 15+ years in complementary roles: defining test strategy, driving continuous improvement, and analyzing complex business processes across FinTech, Pharma, Healthcare, and E-commerce, earlier building 15+ years of client-facing leadership in Tourism, Healthcare patient services, and Corporate/Government sales. Deep expertise in AI-driven test automation. QA management and business analysis across global, multicultural teams, guiding engineers through mentoring, with data-backed quality metrics and strong stakeholder collaboration.

WORK EXPERIENCE

QA Technical Lead & Business Analyst Globant	Aug 2021 - Apr 2026
• Key Project: Generative AI QA — Technical Lead (Jan–Apr 2026):	
• Piloted AI agents across all QA areas of an AI-powered web application build. • Analyzed and designed test cases, test plans, and user stories with BDD acceptance criteria, presenting demos to stakeholders. • Led automated testing design with Playwright and AI agents (Coda AI, Copilot).	
• Key Project: Fiserv & IPG LATAM Payment Gateway — LATAM QA Technical Lead (2023–2026):	
• Directed QA strategy across regions, coordinating global Onsite/Offshore teams, estimating project scope, and reporting quality metrics to stakeholders. • Tested APIs and web services (backend) and designed stress test scenarios with JMeter, mirroring production traffic to validate performance. • Drove test automation and used AI to support test plan design, managing artifacts in Jira, Xray, and Confluence. • Applied agile methodologies across QA delivery — documentation, metrics, onboarding, RCA, and test plan sign-off for release readiness, driving continuous improvement.	
• Key Project: Cerifi, E-Learning — QA Technical Lead (2022–2023):	
• Led a large Globant QA team as technical lead for an E-Learning client, applying Kanban with weekly client demos. • Tested APIs with Postman and deployed to production via Strapi, passing audits with no findings and earning client praise. • Defined acceptance criteria, improving team velocity by 20%.	
• Key Project: CNA, Insurance — QA Technical Lead (2022):	
• Owned end-to-end QA delivery for an insurance portal, managing the client relationship. • Applied shift-left testing on Web and Angular applications, cutting defect detection time by 40%. • Authored BRD and functional documentation to shape QA strategy.	
• Key Project: VIX OTT App, Streaming — Sr QA Focal (2021):	
• Joined at project phase 0, defining testing from the ground up for Android mobile, Google TV, and Fire TV. • Authored test plans and test cases for user stories in Xray, writing BDD cases (Given/When/Then). • Tested frontend incrementally across all three technologies up to the first version ready for UAT, using ADB and Charles Proxy.	
• Key Project: Mentorship:	
• Certified QC Lead and Career Mentor, guiding 20+ mentees in career development. • Supported 80% of mentees in achieving a promotion within 18 months. • Delivered AI learning sessions and coached teams on Scrum practices and cross-functional collaboration.	
QA Lead Analyst Wunderman Thompson	Mar 2021 - Aug 2021
Client: Janssen (J&J)	
• Led QA and supported requirements analysis for pharma digital marketing assets (websites, email campaigns, and more) under FDA and GxP compliance, delivering weekly to meet client and regulatory requirements. • Ensured 100% regulatory adherence across 4 product launches and 120+ deliverables. • Executed exploratory, black box, white box, smoke, and acceptance testing across Litmus, On Acid, VEEVA CRM, and Salesforce. • Conducted RCA on critical defects, cutting recurrence by 30% and shortening release cycles by 2 weeks.	
Sr QA Analyst Business Analyst ST Consultores	Mar 2011 - Jan 2020
Client: BPS – Banco de Previsión Social (Uruguay)	
• Designed and executed functional and end-to-end test suites for .NET applications, covering batch mass processes, web services (SOAP), and Bizagi functionality. • Executed tests on relational and NoSQL databases, ensuring data integrity and successful technology migration. • Coordinated UAT cycles with RCA on critical defects. • Elicited requirements through interviews, workshops, and document analysis for government financial modules, authoring BRD, SRS, URS, and FRD documents that reduced development rework by 25%. • Mapped 25+ business processes using BPMN, documenting As-Is and To-Be states for 3 system implementations, and participated in the Change Control Board (CCB) evaluating 100+ scope changes with ROI-based impact analysis. • Conducted stakeholder analysis that prevented \$150K+ in unplanned costs.	
Operations & Coordination Supervisor VIDA Servicio de Compañía / Asistencia Hospitalaria Prepaga	Jul 2008 - Jul 20
Client: Healthcare / Patient Care Services	
• Supervised and coordinated operations across Montevideo and 19 regional sub-branches nationwide. • Implemented process improvements and cross-departmental controls to optimize service delivery and team efficiency.	
Administration & Corporate Sales Analyst Ramal Viajes / Agencias de Viajes	Jul 2001 - Jul 2008
Client: Tourism / Travel Agency Operations	
• Managed corporate accounts, government tenders, and end-to-end sales operations for international and regional travel packages. • Handled customer relations, account administration, and contract negotiation for high-value corporate clients.	
Paralegal / Legal Assistant Ministerio de Defensa Nacional (Uruguay)	Jul 1996 - Jul 1999
Client: Government / Public Sector	
• Paralegal / Legal Assistant supporting legal and administrative processes.	

CORE SKILLS

QA Tech Lead: Quality Assurance & Strategy: Test Strategy, QA Strategy, Test Planning, Test Estimation, Continuous Improvement, Risk-Based Testing, Shift-Left Testing. Manual Testing: Functional Testing, Exploratory Testing, Regression Testing, Automated Testing, Security Validation, Accessibility Validation, Compatibility Validation. Execution & Management: Smoke Testing, Defect Lifecycle Management, Defect Tracking, Release Lifecycle Management, QA Metrics & KPIs Reporting. Testing in Production: Canary, Feature Toggles, A/B Testing, Chaos Engineering (mobile app resilience & performance). Domain & Platform Testing: Mobile Apps, Web, Desktop, Cloud, Regulated Industries.

Business Analysis: Requirements & Documentation: BABOK Framework, Requirements Elicitation, BRD, SRS, URS, FRD, User Stories, Acceptance Criteria. Analysis & Strategy: Gap Analysis, Cost-Benefit Analysis, SWOT Analysis, MoSCoW Prioritization. Process Modeling: BPMN, ERD, DFD. Change & Governance: Change Control Board (CCB), Root Cause Analysis (RCA), Impact Analysis, Change Management. Data & Reporting: Data Analysis, SQL, Data Visualization.

Agile Methodologies: Sprint Planning, Daily Standup, Sprint Review, Retrospective, Backlog Refinement, Story Points, Velocity Tracking, Definition of Done (DoD), SAFe, Kanban, SDLC.

Domain Expertise: FinTech, Payment Gateways, Base24, Clover, Transaction Processing, Regulatory Compliance, EdTech, OTT Streaming, Pharma GxP/FDA, Healthcare HIPAA & Patient Care Services, Insurance Claims, Government / Public Sector, Tourism & Travel Agency Operations, Corporate & Government Sales, Legal / Paralegal.

AI & Innovation: AI-Powered Test Generation, Self-Healing Automation, LLM Output Evaluation, Prompt Engineering, Responsible AI Practices, AI-Assisted Testing Methodologies.

API & Services Testing: Postman, SoapUI, REST API, SOAP, Contract Testing, JSON/XML Validation.

CI/CD & DevOps: CI/CD Pipelines, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Docker, Quality Gates, Shift-Left Integration, Boards, Test Plans.

Test Automation: Automation Testing, BDD, Cucumber, Test Automation Frameworks, Test Automation Environments, Automation Strategy Design, Global Automation Initiatives, Team Enablement.

Performance & Monitoring: JMeter, k6, Load Testing, Stress Testing, Scalability Validation, Bottleneck Analysis, Kibana, Grafana, Production Monitoring.

Technical: Oracle DB, Strapi, Web Services, Linux, Data Modeling.

Tools: Jira, Xray, Confluence, Coda, Azure DevOps, TestRail, Git, GitHub, SQL, MS Office Suite.

Leadership: Global Team Leadership, Multicultural Teams, Mentoring, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Stakeholder Management, Onsite/Offshore Coordination, Conflict Resolution, Strategic Thinking, Process Innovation, Continuous Improvement.

Coaching: QA Automation Coaching, Testers Upskilling, API Testing Coaching, QA Strategy Development, QA Onboarding, Workshops.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- Enterprise AI Solution & AI Pilot Web Certification - Globant (2026)
- AI Coda Solution Certification - Globant (2026)
- Certified Mentor Trainer & Leader (PMBOK) - Globant (2024)
- ISTQB Certified Tester Foundation Level (CTFL v4.0) (2015)
- Agile Methodologies - Florencia Rossy (2018)
- Airline Reservation & Ticketing Management (IATA) - Amadeus (2001)
- Bachelor of Law (Legal Assistant / Procurator) - UDELAR (1998)

LANGUAGES

- Spanish — Native
- English — Working B2
- Portuguese — Intermediate